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The Cabinet Office Honours Secretariat
10 South Colonnade
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April 26, 2026

Dear Sir or Madam,

Re: Letter of support for Professor Dhiraj Gupta

I am Professor Qutub Syed, formerly Regional Director of the Health Protection Agency for the North West of England, and Centre Director for Cheshire and Merseyside at Public Health England. In those roles I had population-level oversight of the same communities Professor Dhiraj Gupta has served clinically since 2007. I have known him professionally for fifteen years and I write in unreserved support of his nomination for appointment to the Order of the British Empire.

Professor Gupta is, in my considered view, one of the most prominent cardiac electrophysiologists currently practising in the United Kingdom. He has been a Consultant Cardiologist and Electrophysiologist at the Liverpool Heart and Chest Hospital since 2007. He has built one of the highest-volume atrial fibrillation ablation practices in the country, with consistently more than two hundred cases per year since 2009 and over two thousand procedures completed to date. He holds NHS Clinical Excellence Awards at local, national Bronze and national Silver levels, an Honorary Professorship at the University of Liverpool and a Senior Lectureship at Imperial College London, sits on the Council of the British Heart Rhythm Society, and has authored more than two hundred and fifty peer-reviewed publications supported by approximately five million pounds in competitive research funding. He has served as Chief Investigator on several multicentre practice-changing clinical research studies, including PRESSURE, SMANPAF, PRAISE and CRAFT, the findings of which have substantively informed contemporary clinical practice in atrial fibrillation ablation.

His international standing is correspondingly high. He is a frequent invited speaker at the major international scientific meetings, including the Heart Rhythm Society sessions, the American Heart Association Scientific Sessions and the American College of Cardiology Annual Scientific Session in the United States, the European Society of Cardiology Congress and the European Heart Rhythm Association Congress in Europe, and the Asia Pacific Heart Rhythm Society Congress, and is routinely placed on thought leadership and opinion panels alongside the field's most senior global figures. He sits on the editorial boards of *Europace*, the journal of the

European Society of Cardiology, and the Journal of the American College of Cardiology, and holds Fellowship of the American College of Cardiology, journals which are considered the premier cardiology and cardiac electrophysiology globally.

Aside these academic distinctions, the quality of Professor Gupta's clinical expertise is evidenced by the volume of international proctoring he is invited to undertake: cardiologists across Europe, the United States and Asia routinely request his presence, both to perform complex ablation cases and to educate local teams. He is, by common assessment within the field, a gifted speaker and educator as well as a high-quality operator. He has more recently extended this work to India. In March and April of this year he conducted structured workshops at Chandigarh, Ahmedabad, Mumbai and Pune, performing highly complex electrophysiology procedures for patients without charge and training local cardiologists alongside each case. The model is deliberate: rather than the conventional visiting-consultant pattern, local teams participate actively, so that capacity remains long after his departure. The work has been undertaken at his own cost.

I am, however, most directly placed to speak to his contribution in Cheshire and Merseyside, where my own professional responsibilities lay. Through the Liverpool Heart and Chest Hospital, the largest specialist cardiothoracic centre in the United Kingdom, he has provided the regional electrophysiology service for a population of 2.8 million. His Primary Care Atrial Fibrillation service, recognised at the British Medical Association House and at the British Cardiac Society, has improved stroke prevention initiatives for patients managed in the community, and his Palpitations and Arrhythmia pathway, developed jointly with primary care, has streamlined the management of arrhythmia across our region. His authorship of the British Heart Foundation's atrial fibrillation booklet for patients, and its Factfiles for general practitioners, has carried that benefit nationally, and speaks to his patient-first and community centric approach to all that he does.

Throughout, what has most struck me about Professor Gupta is that he carries this distinction quietly. He does not mention his awards. He does not enumerate his publications. His humility is not a performance; it is a settled part of his character. He has been a bastion of healthcare in the United Kingdom and represented British medicine internationally not through self-promotion but through example, and the lasting form of his service, training others to carry the work forward, is itself a measure of the man.

I support his nomination wholeheartedly and without reservation. I would be glad to provide any further information that may assist the Committee.

Yours faithfully,

Professor Qutub Syed
Formerly Regional Director, Health Protection Agency, North West England
Formerly Centre Director, Cheshire and Merseyside, Public Health England